

Power: Monarchy and Democracy in Britain c.1000 to 2014 (J410/09)

This British thematic study focuses on patterns of change and continuity in Power: Monarchy and Democracy in Britain over a long period of British history, c.1000 to 2014. This includes a broad sweep of time in which Britain is ruled by monarchs and which then develops into constitutional monarchies and finally parliamentary democracy.

Covering over 1000 years, the thematic study is a different type of historical practice from the depth studies and even the period study. The broad sweep of time covered by the unit precludes the listing of specific events in the manner of other parts of the specification.

Therefore, the study is divided into three eras and these eras are divided into broad sections. The eras and sections have been chosen as vehicles through which learners can investigate a number of key themes.

- Individuals, institutions and groups with power – particular institutions, groups and individuals holding power (such as monarchs, feudal

aristocracy, gentry, elected representatives) and the social and political structures which have divided these elites from those they rule.

- Claims to power – the basis used by individuals or groups to acquire and hold on to power (such as religious claims, legal claims, hereditary principles, democratic principles, force).
- Methods of maintaining power – the methods used by individuals or groups to maintain themselves in power (such as military force, religion, propaganda and control of information, role of specific ideas and or institutions, negotiation and compromise).
- Challenges to power and power changing hands – different reasons why (such as religion, political ideology, ambition) and ways in which those in authority have been challenged (such as popular uprisings, power struggles within and between elites).

c.1000–c.1485 Themes: • Individuals, institutions and groups with power • Claims to power • Methods of maintaining power • Challenges to power and power changing hands	Anglo-Saxon kingship c.1000–1066: the basis of kingship; the power and responsibilities of the kings; relations between the kings and the thegns. Different claims to the throne in 1066: the Norman invasion, including the establishment of the Norman monarchy and the transfer of power from Saxons to Normans at all levels of society; the extent of the power of the monarch and the barons by 1087. Struggles over power: John’s ascension and early revolts against his rule; John and Magna Carta; emergence of Parliament in the reigns of Henry III and Edward I, including the role and importance of Simon de Montfort; deposition of Richard II in 1399; Wars of the Roses.
c.1485–c.1800 Themes: • Individuals, institutions and groups with power • Claims to power • Methods of maintaining power • Challenges to power and power changing hands	Tudor government: growth of royal power under Henry VIII; the role of Parliament under Henry VIII and Elizabeth I. Defeat and return of monarchy: Charles I’s personal rule 1629–1640; the Civil Wars and the abolition of the monarchy; the Restoration of the monarchy in 1660. James II’s rule and the reasons for the 1688 Revolution (The Glorious Revolution); the legacy of the Glorious Revolution including the Bill of Rights; the development of Parliament under William III and Anne; the emergence of political parties and the development of a Parliamentary monarchy in the course of the 1700s.
c.1800–2014 Themes: • Individuals, institutions and groups with power • Claims to power • Methods of maintaining power • Challenges to power and power changing hands	The changing relationship between Parliament and people c.1800 to c.1918: dissatisfaction with electoral system by early 1800s; reasons for and impacts of the Parliamentary Reform Acts of 1832, 1867 and 1884; the rise and effectiveness of mass Trade Unions and the Labour Party 1880s–1914; the struggle for the vote for women and the reasons why it was won for some women in 1918. The changing relationship between Parliament and people c.1914–c.1980: government control in the world wars; the increased role of the state from 1945 to c.1980. Challenges to Parliament c.1980 to early 2000s: the Miners’ Strike 1984–1985, CND and Greenpeace; Prime Ministerial power under Thatcher and Blair; the devolution of power to regions of the UK; the challenges of coalition government.